

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The paralegal role at Haynes and Boone in investment management genuinely interests me because the work sits at the intersection of fund formation, investor due diligence and securities compliance, areas I have been actively building toward since an A&O Shearman open day in August 2026 introduced me to how PE transactions are structured and how lenders take security across different asset classes. I followed that up with a self-directed Coursera course on private equity, covering fund structures, leverage and exit strategies, and the Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance programme, which put financing and security concepts into a transactional context. This role is the next practical step in that direction.

My most directly relevant experience is at BCLP, where I spent a year on placement across international arbitration and real estate disputes. In the arbitration team, I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a major submission deadline. I coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure the Claimant's memorial was filed on time. That required the kind of file and deadline management the investment management context demands, where subscription documents and AML/KYC processes run to fixed timescales with serious consequences for delay. I also liaised directly with the client about required documents and coordinated external translators, which gave me practical experience of managing stakeholder communication across a matter.

At Adobe, I reviewed and amended software licensing agreements, assessed data-processing provisions against UK and EU GDPR, and coordinated with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries. The work required me to spot legal risk in commercial documentation and communicate that clearly to non-lawyers, which maps closely to supporting attorneys on contract matters and investor intake. Separately, at Q-Legal I managed a data-privacy advisory matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, researching obligations around children's personal data and adtech under the Data Protection Act 2018 and translating those into commercially focused recommendations for a start-up client.

Haynes and Boone's investment management practice handles the full lifecycle of fund-related work, from formation through to ongoing compliance, and that breadth is what makes this role a meaningful step rather than a lateral move. My background in document review, deadline-driven file management, client-facing communication and commercial research gives me a solid base to contribute from the outset.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva